

MANEESH AGNIHOTRI



Under Pressure

LUCKNOW Uttar Pradesh Governor T.V. Rajeswar must be repenting his decision to appoint V.K. Suri as the vice-chancellor of Kanpur's Chandra-shekhar Azad Agriculture University. Suri was at the forefront of the controversy over denial of permission to Rahul Gandhi, Congress general secretary and MP from Amethi, for an interaction with the university students on October 22.

The Congress scion was taken aback when he

was told by the university officials that he did not have permission to interact with the students. Rahul then had to walk up to the canteen to meet the students.

An infuriated state Congress President Rita Bahuguna Joshi accused Chief Minister Mayawati of creating roadblocks for Congress President Sonia Gandhi and her son Rahul. "First, she denied Sonia Gandhi permission for *bhoomi puja* for the rail coach factory in Rae

LEARNING HIS LESSON: Governor Rajeswar

Bareilly. Now her Government has barred Rahul Gandhi to meet the students. This is also a clear case of security breach for an SPG protectee like him."

Later, Cabinet Secretary Shashank Shekhar Singh refuted the Congress charges. Rajeswar, a trusted man of the Gandhi family and the chancellor of all the state universities, has sought an explanation from Suri.

It's time the governor gave a thought to appointment of vice-chancellors most of whom either succumb to political pressures or are found to be involved in corruption cases. In the last four years, half-a-dozen vice-chancellors, most of them appointed by Rajeswar, were either arrested or suspended. In this case, even if Suri acted under pressure to serve Mayawati Government's political interests, the onus is on the governor to set his flock right.

by Subhash Mishra

SIGNPOSTS

WON: By Delhi's **Ratnika Batra**, 14, the national tennis championship. She is the youngest national tennis champion ever.

PHAMOD PUSHPANNA



SENTENCED: Former Sikkim chief minister **Nar Bahadur Bhandari** to six months

imprisonment by a CBI court in Gangtok in connection with a rural water supply scheme scam.

WON: By **Ashutosh Gowariker's** movie *Jodha Akbar*, the Grand Pix award at the Golden Minbar, the film festival for Muslim cinema at Kazan in Russia.

FORMED: By the Tamil Nadu Government, the new district of **Tirupur**, carved out from Coimbatore and Erode districts.

DIED: Professor **Pritam Singh**, Sikh scholar, academician and recipient of the Shiromani Sahitya Award.

VIS-A-VIS **MANMOHAN SINGH** prime minister **versus** **SITARAM YECHURY** CPI(M) Politburo member

All parties which are committed to secularism and nationalism must work together against communal and regional divide.



SAURABH SINGH

If the **CONCERN** for secularism is so sincere then all this should have been thought before rushing into surrender to the US.

EPILOGUE: The nuclear deal is through, but its fallout just doesn't go away.